

Rajesh Dammala

Site Reliability Engineer — High-Availability Cloud, Automation & Incident Management

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Open to Remote / Hybrid / On-site

<https://rdammala.github.io/RD-SRE/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Site Reliability Engineer with 16+ years operating high-availability cloud platforms and building developer-grade automation. Designs monitoring/alerting strategies, owns incident/problem/change management to maintain SLAs, and partners with R&D so features ship reliable, scalable, secure, and easily deployable. Pioneered AI-assisted incident automation (30-35% auto-resolution) and reduced resolution time 32% while lifting operational efficiency from 85% to 98%.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

16+ Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering
100% SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services
30-35% Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation
25,000+ Stale Incidents Eliminated
85%!'98% Operational Efficiency Lift
15-32 Engineers Led Across Global Teams

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Architected AI-driven incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution across a 24/7/365 high-availability platform.
- Sustained 100% SLA across 20+ mission-critical services through disciplined incident, problem, and change management.
- Developed Python/PowerShell tooling that eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts; cut alert fatigue ~90%.
- Reduced resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency from 85% to 98%.
- Partnered with R&D to make features reliable, scalable, secure, and easily deployable; authored 175+ runbooks.
- Coordinated 15-32 engineers across distributed teams, establishing governance, metrics, and a culture of ownership and continuous improvement.
- Drove AI/GenAI adoption (Copilot, Claude) for log summarization, code comprehension, and automation — accelerating mean time to resolution.
- Led incident, problem, and change management across 100+ services, sustaining 99.95%+ availability and authoring 175+ runbooks.
- Delivered cloud-migration patterns and IaC frameworks that modernized large-scale enterprise applications with minimal downtime.
- Built monitoring, alerting, and executive reporting that surfaced SLA risk early and improved operational efficiency from 85% to 98%.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Reliability & Operations: High-Availability Cloud Operations, Incident & Problem Management, SLI / SLO, On-Call & Diagnostics, Root-Cause Analysis, Service Upgrades

Programming & Automation: Python, PowerShell, Bash, C# / .NET (working), Automated Testing, Tooling & Integrations

Cloud & Infrastructure: Microsoft Azure, AWS / GCP (concepts), Kubernetes (AKS/EKS), Terraform, Scalability & Performance

Observability: Azure Monitor / AppInsights, Kusto (KQL), Grafana / Datadog (concepts), Metrics / Logs / Traces, Dashboards & Alerting

CI/CD & DevOps: Azure DevOps, GitHub / Git, CI/CD Pipelines, Infrastructure as Code, Agile Development

AI & Collaboration: AI-Assisted Incident Automation, GenAI Tooling (Copilot), R&D Partnership, Stakeholder Communication, Runbooks & Documentation

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

High-Availability Cloud Operations — **Expert**

Incident & Problem Management (SLA ownership) — **Expert**

Automation & Tooling (Python / PowerShell) — **Expert**

Monitoring & Alerting (Azure Monitor / KQL) — **Advanced**

CI/CD & Infrastructure as Code (Terraform) — **Advanced**

Cloud-Native Architecture (Azure) — **Advanced**

AI-Assisted Automation — **Advanced**

C# / .NET application development — **Working**

CI/CD & Release Automation — **Advanced**

Containers & Orchestration (Docker / Kubernetes) — **Advanced**

Observability (Metrics / Logs / Traces) — **Advanced**

Stakeholder & Executive Communication — **Expert**

Team Leadership & Mentoring — **Expert**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Site Reliability Engineer / Lead — Xbox Cloud Services

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present

Keeps a 24/7/365 high-availability cloud platform serving millions reliable, scalable, and performant.

- Monitor, manage, and operate cloud services including end-to-end incident management for a high-availability platform; sustained 100% SLA across 20+ services.
- Developed tools and automations in Python and PowerShell (C#/.NET-class tooling) to support operations and growth, eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ redundant alerts.
- Scaled services with monitoring and alerting capabilities (Azure Monitor/AppInsights, Kusto/KQL, Power BI), providing rapid feedback and diagnostics during service disruptions.
- Architected an AI-driven incident-automation platform reaching 30-35% auto-resolution; reduced resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency 85%!98%.
- Worked closely with R&D/Engineering to make new features reliable, easily deployable, and scalable/secure; established a regular operational feedback cycle into engineering teams.

- Maintained SLAs with a business- and customer-centric culture — incident response, problem management, and service upgrades; authored 175+ runbooks/playbooks in 5 months.
- Contributed to communication strategy for internal and external stakeholders conveying service health, SLA tracking, and incident history.
- Automated infrastructure and system-administration tasks and implemented monitoring strategy for rapid diagnostics.
- Mentored and grew engineers (15-32 across teams) into senior and lead roles; established career pathways, performance metrics, and a culture of continuous learning.
- Owned end-to-end deployment lifecycle — design, build, test, deploy — and drove operational reviews, postmortems, and continuous-improvement loops.
- Standardized documentation and knowledge management (175+ runbooks/playbooks, decision trees) to scale self-service resolution across support tiers.
- Acted as SME and escalation authority for high-impact incidents, collaborating with engineering leaders to streamline bug-fix and development cycles.
- Built executive and customer-facing reporting conveying service health, SLA tracking, and incident history to internal and external stakeholders.

Azure Cloud Reliability & Platform Technical Lead — Customer Support Services

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021

Led a 15-engineer team operating high-availability cloud infrastructure and developer tooling.

- Operated high-availability Azure cloud infrastructure; built monitoring/alerting and automation that improved reliability and productivity.
- Developed automation and internal tools (Python/PowerShell) to reduce manual operational effort and support scale.
- Partnered with R&D and Support to improve deployability, performance, and serviceability of features across the SDLC.
- Practiced Agile development with CI/CD (Azure DevOps, Git) and coding for automated testing.
- Built CI/CD pipelines and Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform, Azure DevOps, Git) standardizing deployments with security, compliance, and cost guardrails.
- Designed observability (metrics, logs, traces, dashboards, alerting) giving rapid feedback and diagnostics during service disruptions.
- Partnered cross-functionally with Engineering, Product, and Security to integrate cloud and on-premises services for secure operations.
- Led infrastructure migration methodologies and techniques to migrate large-scale enterprise applications and services.
- Practiced Agile/Scrum and DevOps with coding for automated testing, improving deployment reliability and release cadence.

Operations Lead — Azure Live Site Reliability

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016

Led 12 senior + 20 engineers operating cloud platforms at 99.95%+ SLA.

- Built PowerShell automation across provisioning, monitoring, and remediation saving thousands

of manual hours.

- Designed telemetry, dashboards, and alerting for 100+ services; provided rapid diagnostics during disruptions.
- Led incident, problem, and change management; mentored engineers into technical leads.
- Established SLA/SLO baselines, change-management governance, and on-call readiness across 100+ services at 99.95%+ availability.
- Drove cloud-migration patterns and large-scale enterprise migrations with repeatable, automated frameworks.
- Designed telemetry, dashboards, and alerting for rapid diagnostics; mentored engineers into technical leads.
- Built PowerShell/Python automation across provisioning, monitoring, and remediation, saving thousands of manual hours.

Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

Infrastructure operations and scripting across enterprise environments.

- Server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale migrations; deployed monitoring and patches.
- Scripted repetitive operational tasks to improve consistency and reduce manual effort.
- Administered RHEL/Windows environments, middleware, and databases; performed capacity planning, patching, and performance tuning.
- Authored automation and operational documentation that reduced manual effort and improved consistency.
- Executed server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale migrations; deployed monitoring and patches across enterprise environments.

SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

AI-Driven Incident Automation — Built an AI incident agent (30-35% auto-resolution) integrating telemetry, alerting, and remediation workflows to drive down MTTR.

Monitoring & Alerting at Scale — Designed metrics, dashboards, and alerting (Azure Monitor, KQL, Power BI) providing rapid feedback and diagnostics during disruptions.

Operational Tooling & Automation — Developed Python/PowerShell tools automating infrastructure and sysadmin tasks, eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts.

R&D Reliability Partnership — Established an operational feedback cycle into engineering to ensure new features are reliable, scalable, secure, and easily deployable.

SLA & Service Health Communication — Built executive and customer-facing reporting conveying service health, SLA tracking, and incident history.

CI/CD & Automated Testing — Practiced Agile development with CI/CD (Azure DevOps, Git) and coding for automated testing to raise deployment reliability.

resume-engine-pro (Personal Project) — Open-source Node.js engine that generates ATS-optimized resumes, cover letters, CVs, and themed portfolio sites from structured data — live at rdammala.github.io/resume-engine-pro (GitHub repository link available on a discussion basis; actively iterating on improvements).

Cloud Migration & Modernization — Defined repeatable migration patterns and IaC frameworks to move large-scale enterprise applications to the cloud with minimal downtime.

Observability & SLI/SLO Program — Rolled out metrics/logs/traces standards, dashboards, and alerting that improved detection and cut MTTR across the service portfolio.

Knowledge Management & Enablement — Built a documentation strategy (runbooks, decision trees, playbooks) that scaled self-service resolution and reduced escalations.

CI/CD & Release Automation — Designed and governed delivery pipelines (Azure DevOps, GitHub, Jenkins) with automated testing, approvals, and security/compliance gates.

Infrastructure as Code Platform — Standardized Terraform/CloudFormation modules and golden paths enabling self-service, repeatable, and auditable infrastructure provisioning.

AI-Augmented Operations — Introduced GenAI tooling (Copilot, Claude) for log summarization, code comprehension, and SQL/script generation to accelerate resolution.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

Reliability is a development discipline: automate the toil, instrument everything with SLI/SLOs, partner with engineering so features ship reliable and deployable, and treat every incident as a chance to make the system — and the customer experience — better.